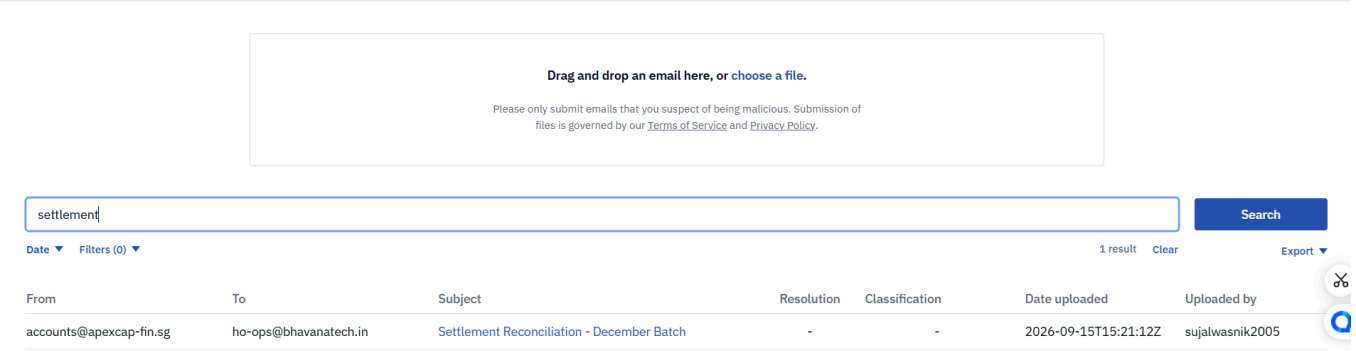
Email Forensics Report

Experiment 5

Name: Sujal Wasnik
UID: 23015036

Item 1 — Triage Approach

📷 Screenshot

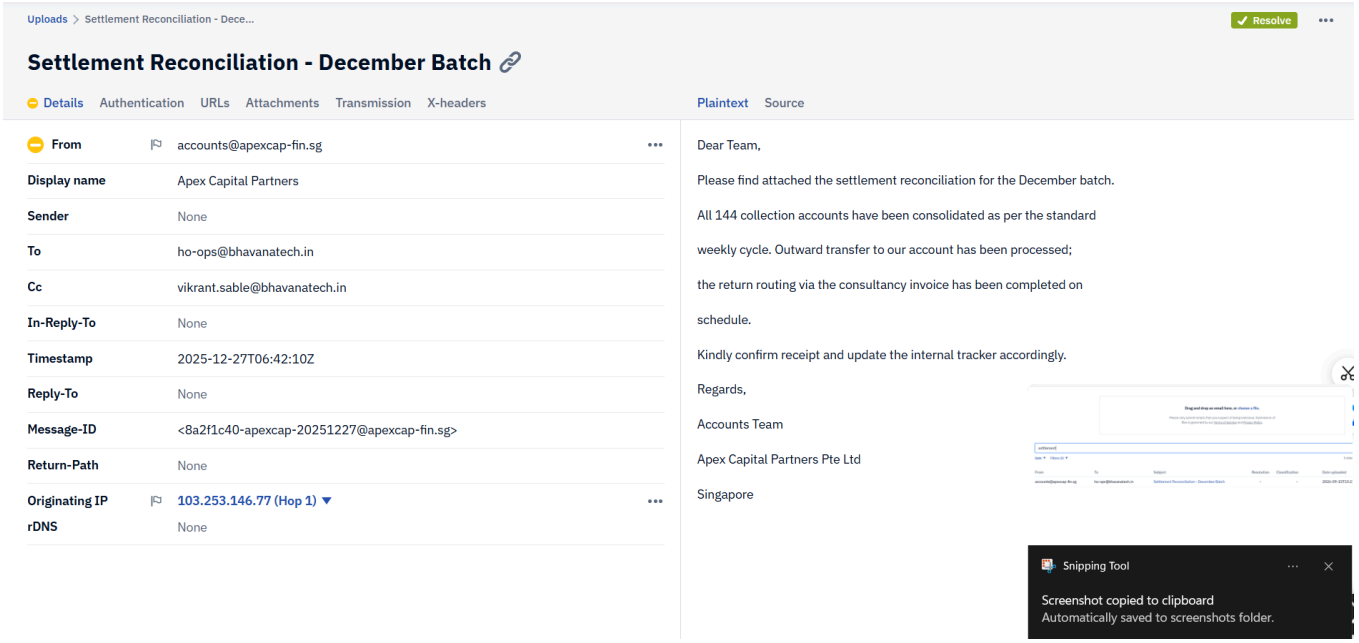


Description

I triaged the mailbox by applying a search filter for the keyword "settlement". This approach was selected to quickly narrow down the results and locate emails related to the suspicious fund transfers mentioned in the case.

Item 2 — Relevant Message(s) Identified

📷 Screenshot

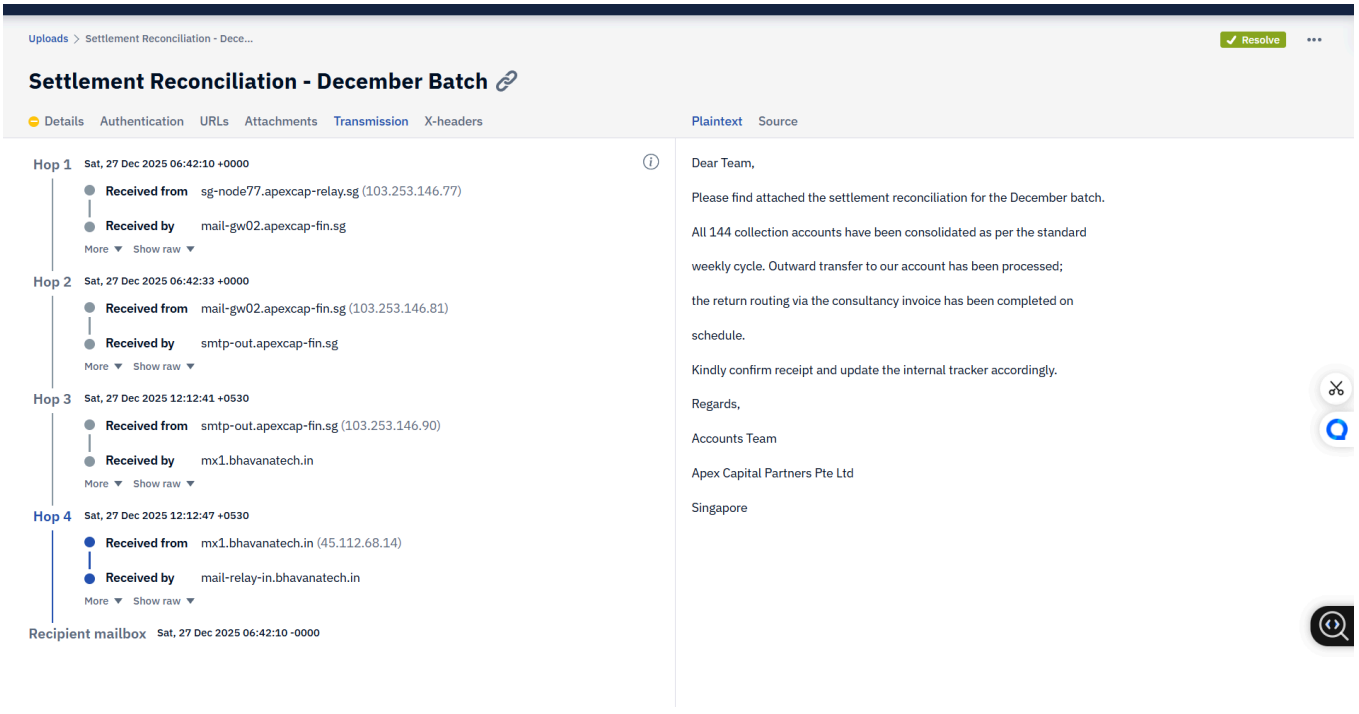


Description

This email was selected as relevant because the sender `accounts@apexcap-fin.sg` directly discusses outward transfers, collection accounts, and settlement routing. The financial nature of the message content made it a primary target for further investigation.

Item 3 — Header Chain Reconstruction

📷 Screenshot



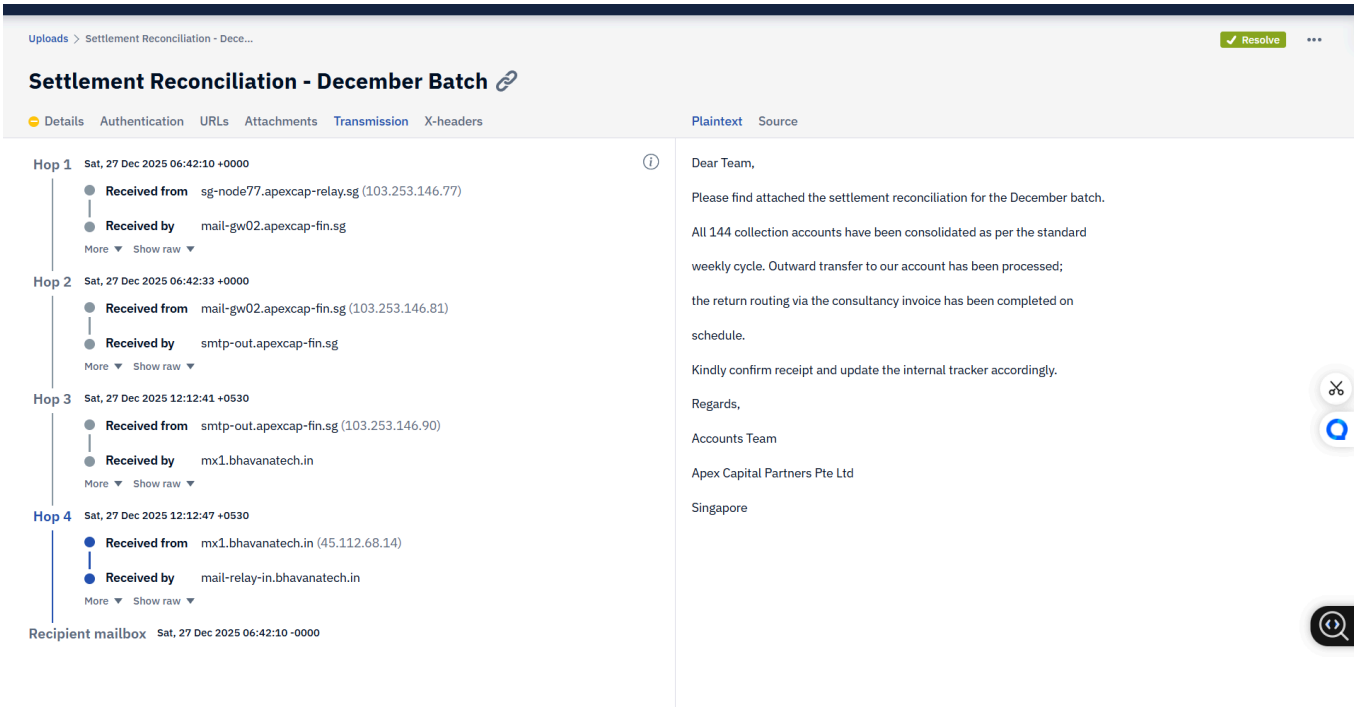
Description

By analyzing the transmission headers, the email's path was reconstructed chronologically across four distinct hops. The message originated from `103.253.146.77` at Hop 1 and passed

through two more relays before arriving at our receiving infrastructure at Hop 4.

Item 4 — Trust Boundary

Screenshot

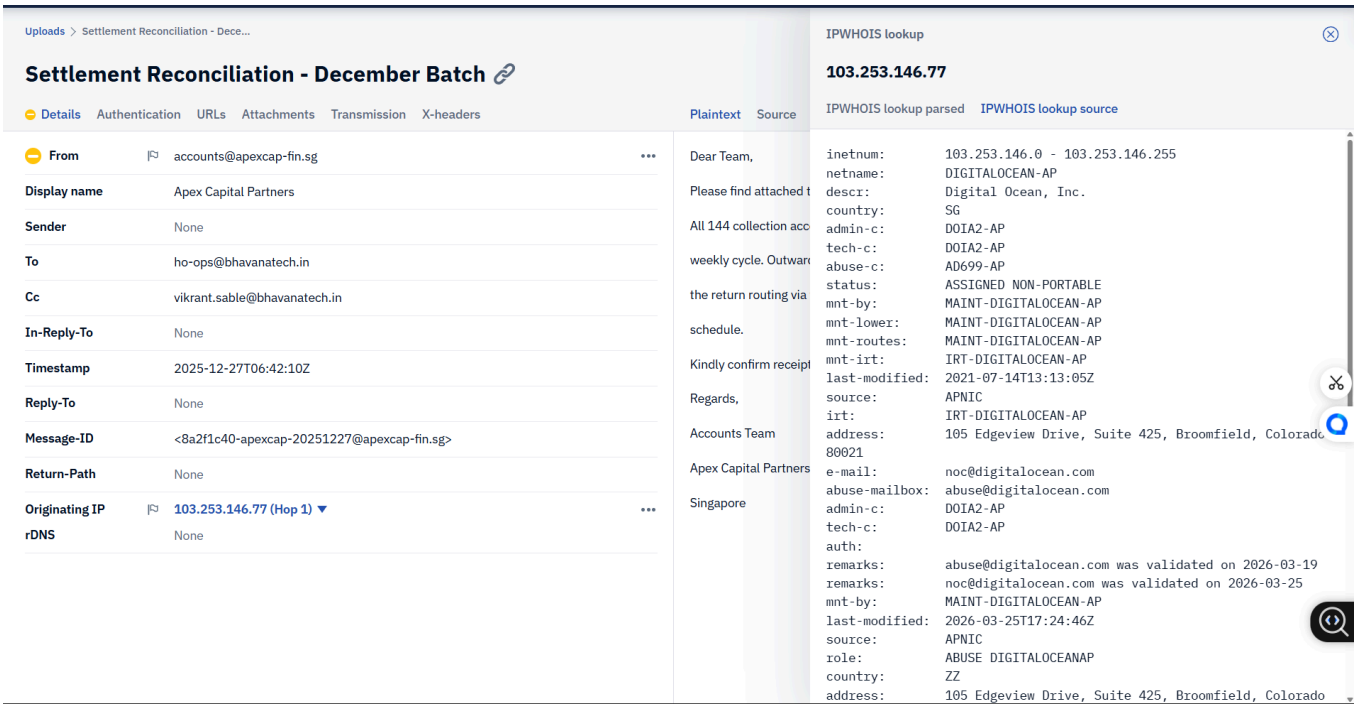


Description

The trust boundary is established at Hop 4, which represents our organization's internal receiving mail infrastructure. Any routing details recorded prior to this boundary are considered external evidence and must be independently verified for accuracy.

Item 5 — IP Lookup Result

Screenshot

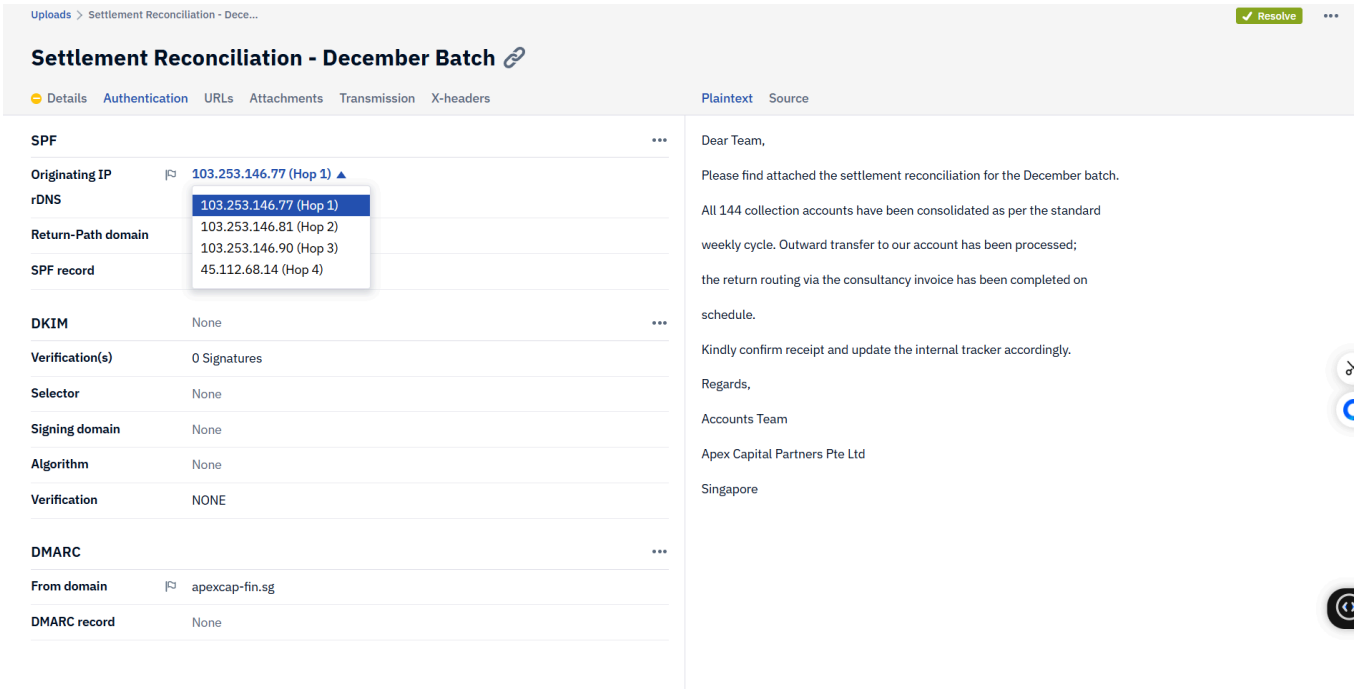


Description

The IPWHOIS lookup on the earliest hop (103.253.146.77) associates the address with Digital Ocean, Inc. The lookup result also geolocates the IP to Singapore (SG), which provides context about the sender's origin.

Item 6 — Authentication Results

Screenshot

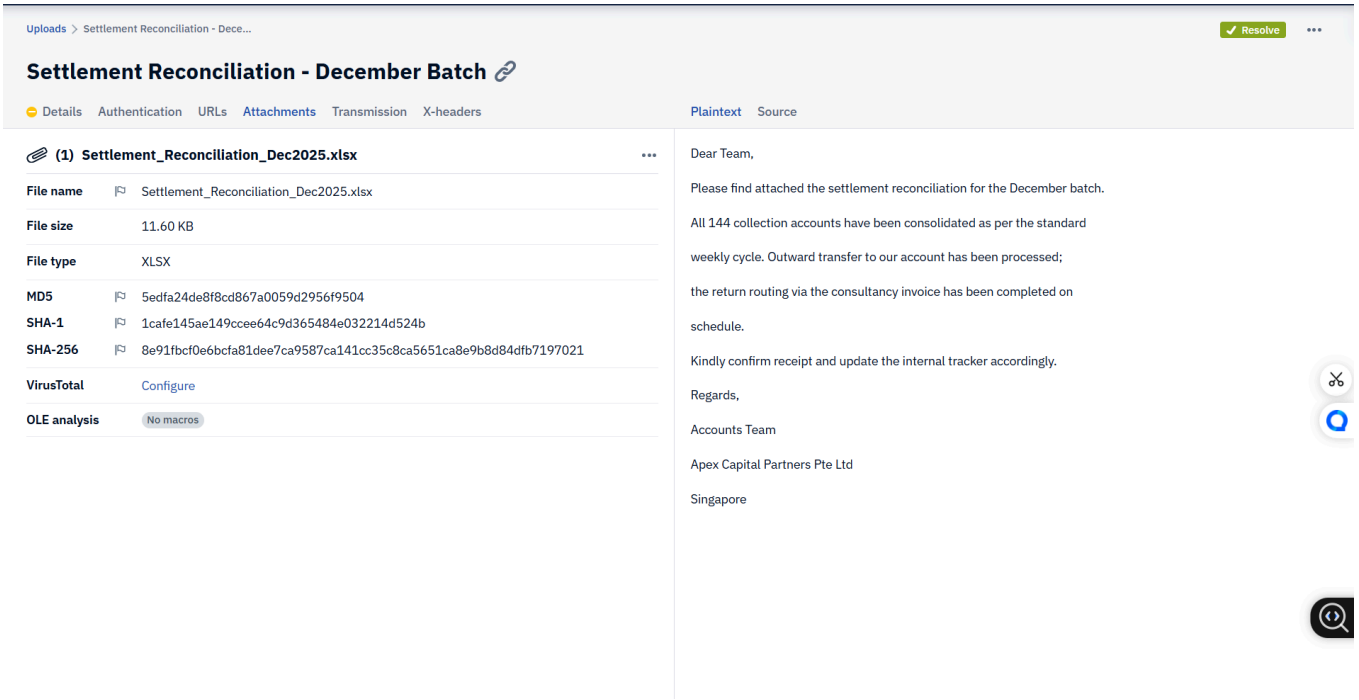


Description

The authentication results indicate that while SPF was recorded for the Hop 1 IP, both DKIM and DMARC returned a result of "None". This shows that the email lacks DKIM signatures and DMARC policies, meaning its cryptographic authenticity cannot be fully verified.

Item 7 — Attachment Analysis

📷 Screenshot

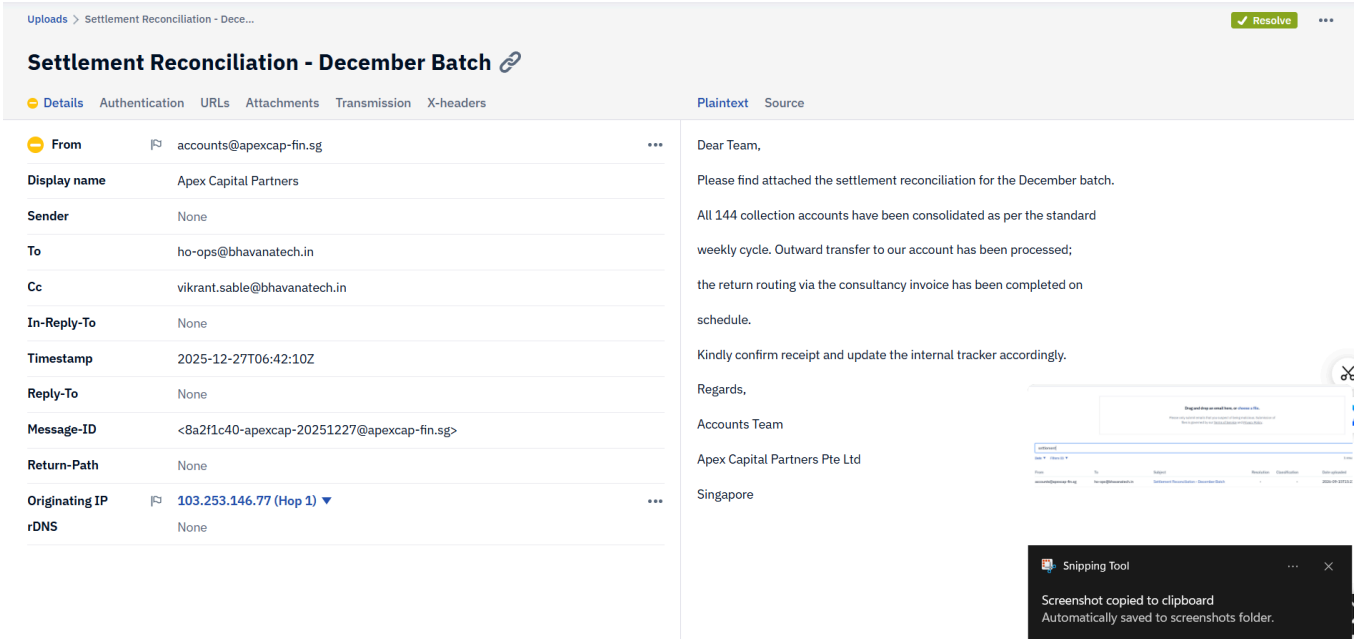


Description

The email contains an attached spreadsheet named `Settlement_Reconciliation_Dec2025.xlsx`. This file is highly relevant to the investigation as it likely contains the consolidated collection accounts and financial transaction details mentioned in the email body.

Item 8 — CC Field Finding

📷 Screenshot



Description

The CC field establishes that `vikrant.sable@bhavanatech.in` was included as a copied recipient on the communication. However, this only shows they received a copy and does not establish that they read the email, approved it, or actively participated in the transaction.

CFT Findings

`CFT{S1NG@P0R3_L1nk_C0Nf1rm3d}`

`CFT{103.253.146.77}`

`CFT{4_HOPS_HOP_4_IS_ORIGIN}`